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instances of this tactic was against Shaun Marsh in the 2018 Melbourne Test. Bumrah had Marsh anticipating another length ball or outswinger. Instead, the Australian left-hander was surprised by a cunning off-cutter that swerved in, trapping him plumb in front of the

stumps. Such moments underline Bumrah's ability to innovate, incorporating elements like the off-cutter that are typically more prevalent in limited-overs cricket, into the longer format.

Bumrah's mastery of the off-cutter stems from his extensive

experience in T20s, where he has refined this skill under conditions that demand precision and minimal margin for error. The added wrist snap he applies to his slower deliveries increases revolutions on the ball, making it dip abruptly and swerve after pitching. This technique not only creates unpredictability but also amplifies the difficulty for the batter.

From 2018 to 2023, Bumrah's use of slower deliveries in Tests was sporadic. However, 2024 marked a significant shift. This year, Bumrah has bowled an average of 8.71 slower balls per Test, compared to just 1.64 in previous years. This heightened reliance on variations has also translated into wickets, with six out of his 11 slower-ball dismissals coming this year alone — four against England and two against Bangladesh.

India's home conditions, often favourable to spinners, seem to have influenced this change in Bumrah's approach. With the team relying on him to spearhead the attack, he has leveraged his slower variations as a means to disrupt the opposition and pick up crucial wickets.

### Akash's fundamentals and seam movement

On the first morning of the Chennai Test, Akash ran in from around the wicket, delivering only his

#### Jasprit Bumrah's off-cutter/slower ball dismissals in Tests

| Batter                                 | Date        | Overs | Dismissal type | Variation   |
|----------------------------------------|-------------|-------|----------------|-------------|
| <a href="#">F. du Plessis (SA)</a>     | 13 Jan 2018 | 88.4  | caught         | off-cutter  |
| <a href="#">S. E. Marsh (AUS)</a>      | 26 Dec 2018 | 32.6  | lbw            | off-cutter  |
| <a href="#">O. E. Robinson (ENG)</a>   | 12 Aug 2021 | 50.6  | lbw            | slower ball |
| <a href="#">K. I. C. Asalanka (SL)</a> | 4 Mar 2022  | 57.6  | lbw            | off-cutter  |
| <a href="#">A. D. Mathews (SL)</a>     | 12 Mar 2022 | 28.1  | caught         | off-cutter  |
| <a href="#">R. Ahmed (ENG)</a>         | 25 Jan 2024 | 48.3  | caught         | off-cutter  |
| <a href="#">B. A. Stokes (ENG)</a>     | 25 Jan 2024 | 64.3  | bowled         | off-cutter  |
| <a href="#">O. J. D. Pope (ENG)</a>    | 25 Jan 2024 | 102.1 | bowled         | slower ball |
| <a href="#">B. T. Foakes (ENG)</a>     | 2 Feb 2024  | 64.6  | caught         | slower ball |
| <a href="#">Taijul Islam (BAN)</a>     | 27 Sep 2024 | 40.4  | lbw            | off-cutter  |
| <a href="#">Mushfiquir Rahim (BAN)</a> | 27 Sep 2024 | 46.6  | bowled         | off-cutter  |